SKEIN ENGINE

VOLUME 05

FORWARD+, DEFERRED RENDERING AND RENDER FEATURES

Render graph, scene extraction, visibility, clustered Forward+, deferred G-buffer path, shadows, post-processing and presentation.

DOCUMENT CODE	**SKEIN-IMP-002-V05**
VERSION	**0.1**
STATUS	**DRAFT CONSTRUCTION REFERENCE**
PLANNED PAGES	**225**
CHAPTERS	**15**
DATE	**30 July 2026**

IMPLEMENTATION MANUAL / PRINT SET

Current architecture source: SKEIN-SPEC-001 v0.4 and SKEIN-IMP-002-MASTER v0.1

05.01 Renderer module boundaries

Purpose and boundary: scene/render split

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Renderer module boundaries, with particular attention to scene/render split. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Scene/render split is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with frame data is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for scene/render split; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep frame data behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RendererModuleBoundariesService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RendererModuleBoundariesConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RendererModuleBoundariesState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.01 and scene/render split.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.01 Renderer module boundaries

Architecture: frame data

This page defines the architecture for Renderer module boundaries, with particular attention to frame data. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Frame data is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with thread ownership is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for frame data; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep thread ownership behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Renderer", "RendererModuleBoundaries");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.01 and frame data.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.01 Renderer module boundaries

Data model: thread ownership

This page defines the data model for Renderer module boundaries, with particular attention to thread ownership. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Thread ownership is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with plugin points is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for thread ownership; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep plugin points behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RendererModuleBoundariesService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RendererModuleBoundariesConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RendererModuleBoundariesState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.01 and thread ownership.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.01 Renderer module boundaries

Public API: plugin points

This page defines the public api for Renderer module boundaries, with particular attention to plugin points. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Plugin points is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with scene/render split is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for plugin points; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep scene/render split behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Renderer", "RendererModuleBoundaries");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.01 and plugin points.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.01 Renderer module boundaries

Ownership and lifetime: scene/render split

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Renderer module boundaries, with particular attention to scene/render split. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Scene/render split is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with frame data is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for scene/render split; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep frame data behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RendererModuleBoundariesService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RendererModuleBoundariesConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RendererModuleBoundariesState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.01 and scene/render split.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.01 Renderer module boundaries

Threading model: frame data

This page defines the threading model for Renderer module boundaries, with particular attention to frame data. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Frame data is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with thread ownership is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for frame data; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep thread ownership behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Renderer", "RendererModuleBoundaries");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.01 and frame data.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.01 Renderer module boundaries

Memory strategy: thread ownership

This page defines the memory strategy for Renderer module boundaries, with particular attention to thread ownership. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Thread ownership is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with plugin points is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for thread ownership; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep plugin points behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RendererModuleBoundariesService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RendererModuleBoundariesConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RendererModuleBoundariesState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.01 and thread ownership.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.01 Renderer module boundaries

Failure handling: plugin points

This page defines the failure handling for Renderer module boundaries, with particular attention to plugin points. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Plugin points is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with scene/render split is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for plugin points; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep scene/render split behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Renderer", "RendererModuleBoundaries");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.01 and plugin points.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.01 Renderer module boundaries

Diagnostics: scene/render split

This page defines the diagnostics for Renderer module boundaries, with particular attention to scene/render split. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Scene/render split is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with frame data is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for scene/render split; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep frame data behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RendererModuleBoundariesService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RendererModuleBoundariesConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RendererModuleBoundariesState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.01 and scene/render split.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.02 Render graph

Purpose and boundary: pass declarations

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Render graph, with particular attention to pass declarations. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Pass declarations is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with resource lifetimes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for pass declarations; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep resource lifetimes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RenderGraphService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RenderGraphConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RenderGraphState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.02 and pass declarations.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.02 Render graph

Architecture: resource lifetimes

This page defines the architecture for Render graph, with particular attention to resource lifetimes. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Resource lifetimes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with barriers is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for resource lifetimes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep barriers behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Render", "RenderGraph");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.02 and resource lifetimes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.02 Render graph

Data model: barriers

This page defines the data model for Render graph, with particular attention to barriers. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Barriers is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with aliasing is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for barriers; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep aliasing behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RenderGraphService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RenderGraphConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RenderGraphState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.02 and barriers.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.02 Render graph

Public API: aliasing

This page defines the public api for Render graph, with particular attention to aliasing. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Aliasing is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with debug viewer is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for aliasing; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep debug viewer behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Render", "RenderGraph");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.02 and aliasing.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.02 Render graph

Ownership and lifetime: debug viewer

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Render graph, with particular attention to debug viewer. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Debug viewer is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with pass declarations is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for debug viewer; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep pass declarations behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RenderGraphService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RenderGraphConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RenderGraphState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.02 and debug viewer.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.02 Render graph

Threading model: pass declarations

This page defines the threading model for Render graph, with particular attention to pass declarations. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Pass declarations is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with resource lifetimes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for pass declarations; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep resource lifetimes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Render", "RenderGraph");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.02 and pass declarations.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.02 Render graph

Memory strategy: resource lifetimes

This page defines the memory strategy for Render graph, with particular attention to resource lifetimes. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Resource lifetimes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with barriers is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for resource lifetimes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep barriers behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RenderGraphService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RenderGraphConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RenderGraphState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.02 and resource lifetimes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.02 Render graph

Failure handling: barriers

This page defines the failure handling for Render graph, with particular attention to barriers. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Barriers is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with aliasing is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for barriers; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep aliasing behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Render", "RenderGraph");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.02 and barriers.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.02 Render graph

Diagnostics: aliasing

This page defines the diagnostics for Render graph, with particular attention to aliasing. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Aliasing is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with debug viewer is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for aliasing; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep debug viewer behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RenderGraphService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RenderGraphConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RenderGraphState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.02 and aliasing.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.02 Render graph

Implementation sequence: debug viewer

This page defines the implementation sequence for Render graph, with particular attention to debug viewer. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Debug viewer is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with pass declarations is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for debug viewer; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep pass declarations behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Render", "RenderGraph");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.02 and debug viewer.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.02 Render graph

Verification: pass declarations

This page defines the verification for Render graph, with particular attention to pass declarations. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Pass declarations is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with resource lifetimes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for pass declarations; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep resource lifetimes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RenderGraphService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RenderGraphConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RenderGraphState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.02 and pass declarations.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.02 Render graph

Completion gate: resource lifetimes

This page defines the completion gate for Render graph, with particular attention to resource lifetimes. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Resource lifetimes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with barriers is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for resource lifetimes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep barriers behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Render", "RenderGraph");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.02 and resource lifetimes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.02 Render graph

Purpose and boundary: barriers

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Render graph, with particular attention to barriers. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Barriers is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with aliasing is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for barriers; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep aliasing behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RenderGraphService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RenderGraphConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RenderGraphState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.02 and barriers.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.02 Render graph

Architecture: aliasing

This page defines the architecture for Render graph, with particular attention to aliasing. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Aliasing is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with debug viewer is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for aliasing; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep debug viewer behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Render", "RenderGraph");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.02 and aliasing.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.02 Render graph

Data model: debug viewer

This page defines the data model for Render graph, with particular attention to debug viewer. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Debug viewer is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with pass declarations is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for debug viewer; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep pass declarations behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RenderGraphService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RenderGraphConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RenderGraphState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.02 and debug viewer.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.02 Render graph

Public API: pass declarations

This page defines the public api for Render graph, with particular attention to pass declarations. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Pass declarations is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with resource lifetimes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for pass declarations; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep resource lifetimes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Render", "RenderGraph");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.02 and pass declarations.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.02 Render graph

Ownership and lifetime: resource lifetimes

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Render graph, with particular attention to resource lifetimes. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Resource lifetimes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with barriers is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for resource lifetimes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep barriers behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RenderGraphService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RenderGraphConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RenderGraphState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.02 and resource lifetimes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.02 Render graph

Threading model: barriers

This page defines the threading model for Render graph, with particular attention to barriers. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Barriers is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with aliasing is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for barriers; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep aliasing behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Render", "RenderGraph");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.02 and barriers.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.02 Render graph

Memory strategy: aliasing

This page defines the memory strategy for Render graph, with particular attention to aliasing. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Aliasing is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with debug viewer is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for aliasing; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep debug viewer behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RenderGraphService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RenderGraphConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RenderGraphState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.02 and aliasing.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.02 Render graph

Failure handling: debug viewer

This page defines the failure handling for Render graph, with particular attention to debug viewer. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Debug viewer is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with pass declarations is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for debug viewer; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep pass declarations behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Render", "RenderGraph");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.02 and debug viewer.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.03 Scene extraction and render proxies

Purpose and boundary: double buffering

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Scene extraction and render proxies, with particular attention to double buffering. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Double buffering is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with immutable frame packets is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for double buffering; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep immutable frame packets behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SceneExtractionAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SceneExtractionAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SceneExtractionAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.03 and double buffering.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.03 Scene extraction and render proxies

Architecture: immutable frame packets

This page defines the architecture for Scene extraction and render proxies, with particular attention to immutable frame packets. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Immutable frame packets is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with lifetime is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for immutable frame packets; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep lifetime behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Scene", "SceneExtractionAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.03 and immutable frame packets.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.03 Scene extraction and render proxies

Data model: lifetime

This page defines the data model for Scene extraction and render proxies, with particular attention to lifetime. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Lifetime is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with large-world conversion is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for lifetime; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep large-world conversion behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SceneExtractionAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SceneExtractionAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SceneExtractionAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.03 and lifetime.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.03 Scene extraction and render proxies

Public API: large-world conversion

This page defines the public api for Scene extraction and render proxies, with particular attention to large-world conversion. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Large-world conversion is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with double buffering is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for large-world conversion; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep double buffering behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Scene", "SceneExtractionAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.03 and large-world conversion.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.03 Scene extraction and render proxies

Ownership and lifetime: double buffering

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Scene extraction and render proxies, with particular attention to double buffering. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Double buffering is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with immutable frame packets is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for double buffering; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep immutable frame packets behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SceneExtractionAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SceneExtractionAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SceneExtractionAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.03 and double buffering.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.03 Scene extraction and render proxies

Threading model: immutable frame packets

This page defines the threading model for Scene extraction and render proxies, with particular attention to immutable frame packets. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Immutable frame packets is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with lifetime is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for immutable frame packets; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep lifetime behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Scene", "SceneExtractionAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.03 and immutable frame packets.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.03 Scene extraction and render proxies

Memory strategy: lifetime

This page defines the memory strategy for Scene extraction and render proxies, with particular attention to lifetime. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Lifetime is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with large-world conversion is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for lifetime; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep large-world conversion behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SceneExtractionAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SceneExtractionAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SceneExtractionAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.03 and lifetime.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.03 Scene extraction and render proxies

Failure handling: large-world conversion

This page defines the failure handling for Scene extraction and render proxies, with particular attention to large-world conversion. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Large-world conversion is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with double buffering is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for large-world conversion; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep double buffering behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Scene", "SceneExtractionAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.03 and large-world conversion.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.03 Scene extraction and render proxies

Diagnostics: double buffering

This page defines the diagnostics for Scene extraction and render proxies, with particular attention to double buffering. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Double buffering is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with immutable frame packets is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for double buffering; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep immutable frame packets behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SceneExtractionAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SceneExtractionAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SceneExtractionAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.03 and double buffering.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.03 Scene extraction and render proxies

Implementation sequence: immutable frame packets

This page defines the implementation sequence for Scene extraction and render proxies, with particular attention to immutable frame packets. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Immutable frame packets is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with lifetime is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for immutable frame packets; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep lifetime behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Scene", "SceneExtractionAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.03 and immutable frame packets.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.03 Scene extraction and render proxies

Verification: lifetime

This page defines the verification for Scene extraction and render proxies, with particular attention to lifetime. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Lifetime is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with large-world conversion is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for lifetime; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep large-world conversion behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SceneExtractionAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SceneExtractionAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SceneExtractionAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.03 and lifetime.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.03 Scene extraction and render proxies

Completion gate: large-world conversion

This page defines the completion gate for Scene extraction and render proxies, with particular attention to large-world conversion. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Large-world conversion is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with double buffering is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for large-world conversion; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep double buffering behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Scene", "SceneExtractionAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.03 and large-world conversion.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.03 Scene extraction and render proxies

Purpose and boundary: double buffering

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Scene extraction and render proxies, with particular attention to double buffering. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Double buffering is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with immutable frame packets is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for double buffering; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep immutable frame packets behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SceneExtractionAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SceneExtractionAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SceneExtractionAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.03 and double buffering.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.03 Scene extraction and render proxies

Architecture: immutable frame packets

This page defines the architecture for Scene extraction and render proxies, with particular attention to immutable frame packets. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Immutable frame packets is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with lifetime is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for immutable frame packets; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep lifetime behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Scene", "SceneExtractionAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.03 and immutable frame packets.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.03 Scene extraction and render proxies

Data model: lifetime

This page defines the data model for Scene extraction and render proxies, with particular attention to lifetime. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Lifetime is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with large-world conversion is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for lifetime; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep large-world conversion behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SceneExtractionAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SceneExtractionAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SceneExtractionAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.03 and lifetime.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.04 Visibility and culling

Purpose and boundary: frustum

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Visibility and culling, with particular attention to frustum. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Frustum is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with occlusion is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for frustum; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep occlusion behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class VisibilityAndCullingService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const VisibilityAndCullingConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    VisibilityAndCullingState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.04 and frustum.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.04 Visibility and culling

Architecture: occlusion

This page defines the architecture for Visibility and culling, with particular attention to occlusion. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Occlusion is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with LOD is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for occlusion; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep LOD behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Visibility", "VisibilityAndCulling");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.04 and occlusion.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.04 Visibility and culling

Data model: LOD

This page defines the data model for Visibility and culling, with particular attention to LOD. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Lod is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with instancing is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for LOD; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep instancing behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class VisibilityAndCullingService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const VisibilityAndCullingConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    VisibilityAndCullingState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.04 and LOD.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.04 Visibility and culling

Public API: instancing

This page defines the public api for Visibility and culling, with particular attention to instancing. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Instancing is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with GPU-driven path is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for instancing; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep GPU-driven path behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Visibility", "VisibilityAndCulling");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.04 and instancing.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.04 Visibility and culling

Ownership and lifetime: GPU-driven path

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Visibility and culling, with particular attention to GPU-driven path. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Gpu-driven path is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with frustum is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for GPU-driven path; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep frustum behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class VisibilityAndCullingService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const VisibilityAndCullingConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    VisibilityAndCullingState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.04 and GPU-driven path.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.04 Visibility and culling

Threading model: frustum

This page defines the threading model for Visibility and culling, with particular attention to frustum. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Frustum is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with occlusion is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for frustum; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep occlusion behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Visibility", "VisibilityAndCulling");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.04 and frustum.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.04 Visibility and culling

Memory strategy: occlusion

This page defines the memory strategy for Visibility and culling, with particular attention to occlusion. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Occlusion is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with LOD is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for occlusion; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep LOD behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class VisibilityAndCullingService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const VisibilityAndCullingConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    VisibilityAndCullingState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.04 and occlusion.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.04 Visibility and culling

Failure handling: LOD

This page defines the failure handling for Visibility and culling, with particular attention to LOD. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Lod is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with instancing is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for LOD; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep instancing behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Visibility", "VisibilityAndCulling");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.04 and LOD.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.04 Visibility and culling

Diagnostics: instancing

This page defines the diagnostics for Visibility and culling, with particular attention to instancing. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Instancing is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with GPU-driven path is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for instancing; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep GPU-driven path behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class VisibilityAndCullingService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const VisibilityAndCullingConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    VisibilityAndCullingState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.04 and instancing.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.04 Visibility and culling

Implementation sequence: GPU-driven path

This page defines the implementation sequence for Visibility and culling, with particular attention to GPU-driven path. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Gpu-driven path is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with frustum is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for GPU-driven path; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep frustum behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Visibility", "VisibilityAndCulling");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.04 and GPU-driven path.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.04 Visibility and culling

Verification: frustum

This page defines the verification for Visibility and culling, with particular attention to frustum. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Frustum is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with occlusion is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for frustum; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep occlusion behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class VisibilityAndCullingService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const VisibilityAndCullingConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    VisibilityAndCullingState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.04 and frustum.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.04 Visibility and culling

Completion gate: occlusion

This page defines the completion gate for Visibility and culling, with particular attention to occlusion. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Occlusion is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with LOD is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for occlusion; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep LOD behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Visibility", "VisibilityAndCulling");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.04 and occlusion.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.04 Visibility and culling

Purpose and boundary: LOD

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Visibility and culling, with particular attention to LOD. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Lod is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with instancing is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for LOD; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep instancing behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class VisibilityAndCullingService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const VisibilityAndCullingConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    VisibilityAndCullingState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.04 and LOD.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.04 Visibility and culling

Architecture: instancing

This page defines the architecture for Visibility and culling, with particular attention to instancing. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Instancing is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with GPU-driven path is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for instancing; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep GPU-driven path behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Visibility", "VisibilityAndCulling");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.04 and instancing.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.04 Visibility and culling

Data model: GPU-driven path

This page defines the data model for Visibility and culling, with particular attention to GPU-driven path. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Gpu-driven path is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with frustum is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for GPU-driven path; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep frustum behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class VisibilityAndCullingService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const VisibilityAndCullingConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    VisibilityAndCullingState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.04 and GPU-driven path.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.04 Visibility and culling

Public API: frustum

This page defines the public api for Visibility and culling, with particular attention to frustum. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Frustum is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with occlusion is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for frustum; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep occlusion behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Visibility", "VisibilityAndCulling");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.04 and frustum.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.04 Visibility and culling

Ownership and lifetime: occlusion

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Visibility and culling, with particular attention to occlusion. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Occlusion is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with LOD is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for occlusion; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep LOD behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class VisibilityAndCullingService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const VisibilityAndCullingConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    VisibilityAndCullingState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.04 and occlusion.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.05 Lighting data model

Purpose and boundary: light types

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Lighting data model, with particular attention to light types. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Light types is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with units is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for light types; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep units behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class LightingDataModelService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const LightingDataModelConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    LightingDataModelState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.05 and light types.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.05 Lighting data model

Architecture: units

This page defines the architecture for Lighting data model, with particular attention to units. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Units is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with layers is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for units; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep layers behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Lighting", "LightingDataModel");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.05 and units.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.05 Lighting data model

Data model: layers

This page defines the data model for Lighting data model, with particular attention to layers. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Layers is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with cookies is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for layers; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep cookies behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class LightingDataModelService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const LightingDataModelConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    LightingDataModelState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.05 and layers.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.05 Lighting data model

Public API: cookies

This page defines the public api for Lighting data model, with particular attention to cookies. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Cookies is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with probes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for cookies; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep probes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Lighting", "LightingDataModel");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.05 and cookies.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.05 Lighting data model

Ownership and lifetime: probes

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Lighting data model, with particular attention to probes. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Probes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with light types is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for probes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep light types behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class LightingDataModelService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const LightingDataModelConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    LightingDataModelState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.05 and probes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.05 Lighting data model

Threading model: light types

This page defines the threading model for Lighting data model, with particular attention to light types. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Light types is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with units is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for light types; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep units behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Lighting", "LightingDataModel");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.05 and light types.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.05 Lighting data model

Memory strategy: units

This page defines the memory strategy for Lighting data model, with particular attention to units. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Units is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with layers is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for units; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep layers behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class LightingDataModelService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const LightingDataModelConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    LightingDataModelState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.05 and units.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.05 Lighting data model

Failure handling: layers

This page defines the failure handling for Lighting data model, with particular attention to layers. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Layers is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with cookies is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for layers; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep cookies behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Lighting", "LightingDataModel");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.05 and layers.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.05 Lighting data model

Diagnostics: cookies

This page defines the diagnostics for Lighting data model, with particular attention to cookies. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Cookies is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with probes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for cookies; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep probes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class LightingDataModelService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const LightingDataModelConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    LightingDataModelState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.05 and cookies.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.05 Lighting data model

Implementation sequence: probes

This page defines the implementation sequence for Lighting data model, with particular attention to probes. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Probes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with light types is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for probes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep light types behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Lighting", "LightingDataModel");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.05 and probes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.05 Lighting data model

Verification: light types

This page defines the verification for Lighting data model, with particular attention to light types. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Light types is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with units is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for light types; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep units behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class LightingDataModelService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const LightingDataModelConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    LightingDataModelState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.05 and light types.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.05 Lighting data model

Completion gate: units

This page defines the completion gate for Lighting data model, with particular attention to units. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Units is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with layers is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for units; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep layers behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Lighting", "LightingDataModel");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.05 and units.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.05 Lighting data model

Purpose and boundary: layers

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Lighting data model, with particular attention to layers. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Layers is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with cookies is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for layers; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep cookies behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class LightingDataModelService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const LightingDataModelConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    LightingDataModelState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.05 and layers.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.06 Cluster construction and light assignment

Purpose and boundary: 3D clusters

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Cluster construction and light assignment, with particular attention to 3D clusters. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

3d clusters is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with depth slicing is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for 3D clusters; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep depth slicing behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ClusterConstructionAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ClusterConstructionAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ClusterConstructionAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.06 and 3D clusters.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.06 Cluster construction and light assignment

Architecture: depth slicing

This page defines the architecture for Cluster construction and light assignment, with particular attention to depth slicing. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Depth slicing is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with overflow is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for depth slicing; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep overflow behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Cluster", "ClusterConstructionAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.06 and depth slicing.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.06 Cluster construction and light assignment

Data model: overflow

This page defines the data model for Cluster construction and light assignment, with particular attention to overflow. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Overflow is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with GPU kernels is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for overflow; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep GPU kernels behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ClusterConstructionAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ClusterConstructionAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ClusterConstructionAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.06 and overflow.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.06 Cluster construction and light assignment

Public API: GPU kernels

This page defines the public api for Cluster construction and light assignment, with particular attention to GPU kernels. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Gpu kernels is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with debug is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for GPU kernels; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep debug behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Cluster", "ClusterConstructionAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.06 and GPU kernels.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.06 Cluster construction and light assignment

Ownership and lifetime: debug

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Cluster construction and light assignment, with particular attention to debug. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Debug is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with 3D clusters is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for debug; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep 3D clusters behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ClusterConstructionAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ClusterConstructionAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ClusterConstructionAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.06 and debug.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.06 Cluster construction and light assignment

Threading model: 3D clusters

This page defines the threading model for Cluster construction and light assignment, with particular attention to 3D clusters. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

3d clusters is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with depth slicing is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for 3D clusters; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep depth slicing behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Cluster", "ClusterConstructionAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.06 and 3D clusters.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.06 Cluster construction and light assignment

Memory strategy: depth slicing

This page defines the memory strategy for Cluster construction and light assignment, with particular attention to depth slicing. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Depth slicing is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with overflow is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for depth slicing; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep overflow behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ClusterConstructionAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ClusterConstructionAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ClusterConstructionAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.06 and depth slicing.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.06 Cluster construction and light assignment

Failure handling: overflow

This page defines the failure handling for Cluster construction and light assignment, with particular attention to overflow. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Overflow is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with GPU kernels is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for overflow; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep GPU kernels behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Cluster", "ClusterConstructionAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.06 and overflow.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.06 Cluster construction and light assignment

Diagnostics: GPU kernels

This page defines the diagnostics for Cluster construction and light assignment, with particular attention to GPU kernels. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Gpu kernels is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with debug is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for GPU kernels; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep debug behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ClusterConstructionAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ClusterConstructionAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ClusterConstructionAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.06 and GPU kernels.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.06 Cluster construction and light assignment

Implementation sequence: debug

This page defines the implementation sequence for Cluster construction and light assignment, with particular attention to debug. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Debug is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with 3D clusters is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for debug; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep 3D clusters behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Cluster", "ClusterConstructionAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.06 and debug.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.06 Cluster construction and light assignment

Verification: 3D clusters

This page defines the verification for Cluster construction and light assignment, with particular attention to 3D clusters. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

3d clusters is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with depth slicing is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for 3D clusters; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep depth slicing behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ClusterConstructionAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ClusterConstructionAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ClusterConstructionAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.06 and 3D clusters.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.06 Cluster construction and light assignment

Completion gate: depth slicing

This page defines the completion gate for Cluster construction and light assignment, with particular attention to depth slicing. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Depth slicing is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with overflow is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for depth slicing; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep overflow behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Cluster", "ClusterConstructionAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.06 and depth slicing.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.06 Cluster construction and light assignment

Purpose and boundary: overflow

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Cluster construction and light assignment, with particular attention to overflow. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Overflow is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with GPU kernels is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for overflow; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep GPU kernels behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ClusterConstructionAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ClusterConstructionAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ClusterConstructionAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.06 and overflow.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.06 Cluster construction and light assignment

Architecture: GPU kernels

This page defines the architecture for Cluster construction and light assignment, with particular attention to GPU kernels. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Gpu kernels is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with debug is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for GPU kernels; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep debug behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Cluster", "ClusterConstructionAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.06 and GPU kernels.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.06 Cluster construction and light assignment

Data model: debug

This page defines the data model for Cluster construction and light assignment, with particular attention to debug. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Debug is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with 3D clusters is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for debug; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep 3D clusters behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ClusterConstructionAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ClusterConstructionAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ClusterConstructionAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.06 and debug.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.06 Cluster construction and light assignment

Public API: 3D clusters

This page defines the public api for Cluster construction and light assignment, with particular attention to 3D clusters. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

3d clusters is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with depth slicing is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for 3D clusters; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep depth slicing behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Cluster", "ClusterConstructionAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.06 and 3D clusters.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.06 Cluster construction and light assignment

Ownership and lifetime: depth slicing

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Cluster construction and light assignment, with particular attention to depth slicing. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Depth slicing is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with overflow is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for depth slicing; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep overflow behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ClusterConstructionAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ClusterConstructionAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ClusterConstructionAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.06 and depth slicing.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.07 Forward+ opaque path

Purpose and boundary: depth prepass

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Forward+ opaque path, with particular attention to depth prepass. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Depth prepass is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with material sorting is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for depth prepass; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep material sorting behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ForwardOpaquePathService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ForwardOpaquePathConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ForwardOpaquePathState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.07 and depth prepass.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.07 Forward+ opaque path

Architecture: material sorting

This page defines the architecture for Forward+ opaque path, with particular attention to material sorting. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Material sorting is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with MSAA is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for material sorting; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep MSAA behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Forward", "ForwardOpaquePath");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.07 and material sorting.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.07 Forward+ opaque path

Data model: MSAA

This page defines the data model for Forward+ opaque path, with particular attention to MSAA. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Msaa is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with special materials is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for MSAA; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep special materials behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ForwardOpaquePathService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ForwardOpaquePathConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ForwardOpaquePathState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.07 and MSAA.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.07 Forward+ opaque path

Public API: special materials

This page defines the public api for Forward+ opaque path, with particular attention to special materials. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Special materials is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with depth prepass is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for special materials; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep depth prepass behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Forward", "ForwardOpaquePath");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.07 and special materials.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.07 Forward+ opaque path

Ownership and lifetime: depth prepass

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Forward+ opaque path, with particular attention to depth prepass. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Depth prepass is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with material sorting is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for depth prepass; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep material sorting behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ForwardOpaquePathService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ForwardOpaquePathConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ForwardOpaquePathState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.07 and depth prepass.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.07 Forward+ opaque path

Threading model: material sorting

This page defines the threading model for Forward+ opaque path, with particular attention to material sorting. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Material sorting is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with MSAA is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for material sorting; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep MSAA behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Forward", "ForwardOpaquePath");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.07 and material sorting.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.07 Forward+ opaque path

Memory strategy: MSAA

This page defines the memory strategy for Forward+ opaque path, with particular attention to MSAA. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Msaa is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with special materials is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for MSAA; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep special materials behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ForwardOpaquePathService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ForwardOpaquePathConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ForwardOpaquePathState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.07 and MSAA.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.07 Forward+ opaque path

Failure handling: special materials

This page defines the failure handling for Forward+ opaque path, with particular attention to special materials. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Special materials is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with depth prepass is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for special materials; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep depth prepass behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Forward", "ForwardOpaquePath");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.07 and special materials.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.07 Forward+ opaque path

Diagnostics: depth prepass

This page defines the diagnostics for Forward+ opaque path, with particular attention to depth prepass. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Depth prepass is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with material sorting is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for depth prepass; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep material sorting behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ForwardOpaquePathService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ForwardOpaquePathConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ForwardOpaquePathState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.07 and depth prepass.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.07 Forward+ opaque path

Implementation sequence: material sorting

This page defines the implementation sequence for Forward+ opaque path, with particular attention to material sorting. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Material sorting is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with MSAA is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for material sorting; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep MSAA behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Forward", "ForwardOpaquePath");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.07 and material sorting.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.07 Forward+ opaque path

Verification: MSAA

This page defines the verification for Forward+ opaque path, with particular attention to MSAA. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Msaa is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with special materials is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for MSAA; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep special materials behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ForwardOpaquePathService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ForwardOpaquePathConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ForwardOpaquePathState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.07 and MSAA.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.07 Forward+ opaque path

Completion gate: special materials

This page defines the completion gate for Forward+ opaque path, with particular attention to special materials. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Special materials is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with depth prepass is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for special materials; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep depth prepass behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Forward", "ForwardOpaquePath");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.07 and special materials.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.07 Forward+ opaque path

Purpose and boundary: depth prepass

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Forward+ opaque path, with particular attention to depth prepass. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Depth prepass is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with material sorting is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for depth prepass; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep material sorting behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ForwardOpaquePathService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ForwardOpaquePathConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ForwardOpaquePathState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.07 and depth prepass.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.07 Forward+ opaque path

Architecture: material sorting

This page defines the architecture for Forward+ opaque path, with particular attention to material sorting. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Material sorting is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with MSAA is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for material sorting; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep MSAA behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Forward", "ForwardOpaquePath");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.07 and material sorting.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.07 Forward+ opaque path

Data model: MSAA

This page defines the data model for Forward+ opaque path, with particular attention to MSAA. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Msaa is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with special materials is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for MSAA; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep special materials behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ForwardOpaquePathService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ForwardOpaquePathConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ForwardOpaquePathState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.07 and MSAA.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.07 Forward+ opaque path

Public API: special materials

This page defines the public api for Forward+ opaque path, with particular attention to special materials. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Special materials is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with depth prepass is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for special materials; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep depth prepass behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Forward", "ForwardOpaquePath");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.07 and special materials.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.07 Forward+ opaque path

Ownership and lifetime: depth prepass

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Forward+ opaque path, with particular attention to depth prepass. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Depth prepass is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with material sorting is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for depth prepass; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep material sorting behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ForwardOpaquePathService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ForwardOpaquePathConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ForwardOpaquePathState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.07 and depth prepass.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.08 Deferred G-buffer design

Purpose and boundary: layout

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Deferred G-buffer design, with particular attention to layout. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Layout is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with formats is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for layout; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep formats behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class DeferredBufferDesignService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const DeferredBufferDesignConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    DeferredBufferDesignState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.08 and layout.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.08 Deferred G-buffer design

Architecture: formats

This page defines the architecture for Deferred G-buffer design, with particular attention to formats. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Formats is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with bandwidth is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for formats; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep bandwidth behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Deferred", "DeferredBufferDesign");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.08 and formats.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.08 Deferred G-buffer design

Data model: bandwidth

This page defines the data model for Deferred G-buffer design, with particular attention to bandwidth. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Bandwidth is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with material IDs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for bandwidth; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep material IDs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class DeferredBufferDesignService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const DeferredBufferDesignConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    DeferredBufferDesignState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.08 and bandwidth.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.08 Deferred G-buffer design

Public API: material IDs

This page defines the public api for Deferred G-buffer design, with particular attention to material IDs. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Material ids is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with motion vectors is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for material IDs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep motion vectors behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Deferred", "DeferredBufferDesign");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.08 and material IDs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.08 Deferred G-buffer design

Ownership and lifetime: motion vectors

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Deferred G-buffer design, with particular attention to motion vectors. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Motion vectors is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with layout is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for motion vectors; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep layout behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class DeferredBufferDesignService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const DeferredBufferDesignConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    DeferredBufferDesignState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.08 and motion vectors.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.08 Deferred G-buffer design

Threading model: layout

This page defines the threading model for Deferred G-buffer design, with particular attention to layout. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Layout is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with formats is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for layout; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep formats behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Deferred", "DeferredBufferDesign");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.08 and layout.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.08 Deferred G-buffer design

Memory strategy: formats

This page defines the memory strategy for Deferred G-buffer design, with particular attention to formats. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Formats is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with bandwidth is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for formats; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep bandwidth behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class DeferredBufferDesignService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const DeferredBufferDesignConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    DeferredBufferDesignState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.08 and formats.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.08 Deferred G-buffer design

Failure handling: bandwidth

This page defines the failure handling for Deferred G-buffer design, with particular attention to bandwidth. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Bandwidth is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with material IDs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for bandwidth; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep material IDs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Deferred", "DeferredBufferDesign");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.08 and bandwidth.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.08 Deferred G-buffer design

Diagnostics: material IDs

This page defines the diagnostics for Deferred G-buffer design, with particular attention to material IDs. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Material ids is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with motion vectors is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for material IDs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep motion vectors behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class DeferredBufferDesignService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const DeferredBufferDesignConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    DeferredBufferDesignState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.08 and material IDs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.08 Deferred G-buffer design

Implementation sequence: motion vectors

This page defines the implementation sequence for Deferred G-buffer design, with particular attention to motion vectors. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Motion vectors is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with layout is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for motion vectors; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep layout behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Deferred", "DeferredBufferDesign");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.08 and motion vectors.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.08 Deferred G-buffer design

Verification: layout

This page defines the verification for Deferred G-buffer design, with particular attention to layout. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Layout is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with formats is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for layout; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep formats behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class DeferredBufferDesignService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const DeferredBufferDesignConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    DeferredBufferDesignState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.08 and layout.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.08 Deferred G-buffer design

Completion gate: formats

This page defines the completion gate for Deferred G-buffer design, with particular attention to formats. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Formats is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with bandwidth is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for formats; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep bandwidth behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Deferred", "DeferredBufferDesign");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.08 and formats.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.08 Deferred G-buffer design

Purpose and boundary: bandwidth

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Deferred G-buffer design, with particular attention to bandwidth. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Bandwidth is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with material IDs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for bandwidth; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep material IDs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class DeferredBufferDesignService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const DeferredBufferDesignConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    DeferredBufferDesignState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.08 and bandwidth.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.08 Deferred G-buffer design

Architecture: material IDs

This page defines the architecture for Deferred G-buffer design, with particular attention to material IDs. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Material ids is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with motion vectors is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for material IDs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep motion vectors behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Deferred", "DeferredBufferDesign");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.08 and material IDs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.08 Deferred G-buffer design

Data model: motion vectors

This page defines the data model for Deferred G-buffer design, with particular attention to motion vectors. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Motion vectors is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with layout is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for motion vectors; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep layout behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class DeferredBufferDesignService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const DeferredBufferDesignConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    DeferredBufferDesignState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.08 and motion vectors.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.08 Deferred G-buffer design

Public API: layout

This page defines the public api for Deferred G-buffer design, with particular attention to layout. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Layout is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with formats is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for layout; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep formats behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Deferred", "DeferredBufferDesign");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.08 and layout.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.08 Deferred G-buffer design

Ownership and lifetime: formats

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Deferred G-buffer design, with particular attention to formats. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Formats is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with bandwidth is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for formats; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep bandwidth behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class DeferredBufferDesignService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const DeferredBufferDesignConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    DeferredBufferDesignState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.08 and formats.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.09 Deferred lighting pass

Purpose and boundary: light volumes

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Deferred lighting pass, with particular attention to light volumes. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Light volumes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with cluster reuse is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for light volumes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep cluster reuse behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class DeferredLightingPassService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const DeferredLightingPassConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    DeferredLightingPassState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.09 and light volumes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.09 Deferred lighting pass

Architecture: cluster reuse

This page defines the architecture for Deferred lighting pass, with particular attention to cluster reuse. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Cluster reuse is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with IBL is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for cluster reuse; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep IBL behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Deferred", "DeferredLightingPass");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.09 and cluster reuse.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.09 Deferred lighting pass

Data model: IBL

This page defines the data model for Deferred lighting pass, with particular attention to IBL. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Ibl is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with decals is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for IBL; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep decals behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class DeferredLightingPassService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const DeferredLightingPassConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    DeferredLightingPassState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.09 and IBL.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.09 Deferred lighting pass

Public API: decals

This page defines the public api for Deferred lighting pass, with particular attention to decals. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Decals is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with probes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for decals; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep probes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Deferred", "DeferredLightingPass");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.09 and decals.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.09 Deferred lighting pass

Ownership and lifetime: probes

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Deferred lighting pass, with particular attention to probes. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Probes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with light volumes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for probes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep light volumes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class DeferredLightingPassService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const DeferredLightingPassConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    DeferredLightingPassState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.09 and probes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.09 Deferred lighting pass

Threading model: light volumes

This page defines the threading model for Deferred lighting pass, with particular attention to light volumes. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Light volumes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with cluster reuse is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for light volumes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep cluster reuse behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Deferred", "DeferredLightingPass");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.09 and light volumes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.09 Deferred lighting pass

Memory strategy: cluster reuse

This page defines the memory strategy for Deferred lighting pass, with particular attention to cluster reuse. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Cluster reuse is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with IBL is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for cluster reuse; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep IBL behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class DeferredLightingPassService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const DeferredLightingPassConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    DeferredLightingPassState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.09 and cluster reuse.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.09 Deferred lighting pass

Failure handling: IBL

This page defines the failure handling for Deferred lighting pass, with particular attention to IBL. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Ibl is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with decals is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for IBL; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep decals behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Deferred", "DeferredLightingPass");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.09 and IBL.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.09 Deferred lighting pass

Diagnostics: decals

This page defines the diagnostics for Deferred lighting pass, with particular attention to decals. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Decals is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with probes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for decals; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep probes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class DeferredLightingPassService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const DeferredLightingPassConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    DeferredLightingPassState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.09 and decals.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.09 Deferred lighting pass

Implementation sequence: probes

This page defines the implementation sequence for Deferred lighting pass, with particular attention to probes. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Probes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with light volumes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for probes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep light volumes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Deferred", "DeferredLightingPass");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.09 and probes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.09 Deferred lighting pass

Verification: light volumes

This page defines the verification for Deferred lighting pass, with particular attention to light volumes. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Light volumes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with cluster reuse is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for light volumes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep cluster reuse behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class DeferredLightingPassService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const DeferredLightingPassConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    DeferredLightingPassState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.09 and light volumes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.09 Deferred lighting pass

Completion gate: cluster reuse

This page defines the completion gate for Deferred lighting pass, with particular attention to cluster reuse. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Cluster reuse is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with IBL is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for cluster reuse; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep IBL behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Deferred", "DeferredLightingPass");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.09 and cluster reuse.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.09 Deferred lighting pass

Purpose and boundary: IBL

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Deferred lighting pass, with particular attention to IBL. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Ibl is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with decals is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for IBL; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep decals behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class DeferredLightingPassService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const DeferredLightingPassConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    DeferredLightingPassState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.09 and IBL.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.09 Deferred lighting pass

Architecture: decals

This page defines the architecture for Deferred lighting pass, with particular attention to decals. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Decals is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with probes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for decals; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep probes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Deferred", "DeferredLightingPass");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.09 and decals.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.09 Deferred lighting pass

Data model: probes

This page defines the data model for Deferred lighting pass, with particular attention to probes. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Probes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with light volumes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for probes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep light volumes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class DeferredLightingPassService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const DeferredLightingPassConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    DeferredLightingPassState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.09 and probes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.10 Transparency and special forward passes

Purpose and boundary: sorting

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Transparency and special forward passes, with particular attention to sorting. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Sorting is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with OIT deferral is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for sorting; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep OIT deferral behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class TransparencyAndSpecialService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const TransparencyAndSpecialConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    TransparencyAndSpecialState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.10 and sorting.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.10 Transparency and special forward passes

Architecture: OIT deferral

This page defines the architecture for Transparency and special forward passes, with particular attention to OIT deferral. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Oit deferral is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with particles is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for OIT deferral; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep particles behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Transparency", "TransparencyAndSpecial");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.10 and OIT deferral.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.10 Transparency and special forward passes

Data model: particles

This page defines the data model for Transparency and special forward passes, with particular attention to particles. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Particles is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with hair-like materials is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for particles; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep hair-like materials behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class TransparencyAndSpecialService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const TransparencyAndSpecialConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    TransparencyAndSpecialState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.10 and particles.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.10 Transparency and special forward passes

Public API: hair-like materials

This page defines the public api for Transparency and special forward passes, with particular attention to hair-like materials. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Hair-like materials is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with sorting is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for hair-like materials; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep sorting behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Transparency", "TransparencyAndSpecial");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.10 and hair-like materials.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.10 Transparency and special forward passes

Ownership and lifetime: sorting

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Transparency and special forward passes, with particular attention to sorting. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Sorting is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with OIT deferral is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for sorting; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep OIT deferral behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class TransparencyAndSpecialService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const TransparencyAndSpecialConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    TransparencyAndSpecialState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.10 and sorting.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.10 Transparency and special forward passes

Threading model: OIT deferral

This page defines the threading model for Transparency and special forward passes, with particular attention to OIT deferral. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Oit deferral is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with particles is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for OIT deferral; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep particles behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Transparency", "TransparencyAndSpecial");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.10 and OIT deferral.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.10 Transparency and special forward passes

Memory strategy: particles

This page defines the memory strategy for Transparency and special forward passes, with particular attention to particles. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Particles is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with hair-like materials is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for particles; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep hair-like materials behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class TransparencyAndSpecialService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const TransparencyAndSpecialConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    TransparencyAndSpecialState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.10 and particles.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.10 Transparency and special forward passes

Failure handling: hair-like materials

This page defines the failure handling for Transparency and special forward passes, with particular attention to hair-like materials. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Hair-like materials is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with sorting is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for hair-like materials; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep sorting behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Transparency", "TransparencyAndSpecial");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.10 and hair-like materials.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.10 Transparency and special forward passes

Diagnostics: sorting

This page defines the diagnostics for Transparency and special forward passes, with particular attention to sorting. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Sorting is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with OIT deferral is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for sorting; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep OIT deferral behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class TransparencyAndSpecialService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const TransparencyAndSpecialConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    TransparencyAndSpecialState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.10 and sorting.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.10 Transparency and special forward passes

Implementation sequence: OIT deferral

This page defines the implementation sequence for Transparency and special forward passes, with particular attention to OIT deferral. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Oit deferral is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with particles is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for OIT deferral; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep particles behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Transparency", "TransparencyAndSpecial");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.10 and OIT deferral.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.10 Transparency and special forward passes

Verification: particles

This page defines the verification for Transparency and special forward passes, with particular attention to particles. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Particles is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with hair-like materials is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for particles; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep hair-like materials behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class TransparencyAndSpecialService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const TransparencyAndSpecialConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    TransparencyAndSpecialState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.10 and particles.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.10 Transparency and special forward passes

Completion gate: hair-like materials

This page defines the completion gate for Transparency and special forward passes, with particular attention to hair-like materials. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Hair-like materials is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with sorting is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for hair-like materials; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep sorting behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Transparency", "TransparencyAndSpecial");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.10 and hair-like materials.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.10 Transparency and special forward passes

Purpose and boundary: sorting

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Transparency and special forward passes, with particular attention to sorting. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Sorting is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with OIT deferral is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for sorting; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep OIT deferral behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class TransparencyAndSpecialService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const TransparencyAndSpecialConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    TransparencyAndSpecialState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.10 and sorting.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.11 Shadow architecture

Purpose and boundary: directional cascades

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Shadow architecture, with particular attention to directional cascades. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Directional cascades is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with spot is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for directional cascades; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep spot behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ShadowArchitectureService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ShadowArchitectureConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ShadowArchitectureState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.11 and directional cascades.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.11 Shadow architecture

Architecture: spot

This page defines the architecture for Shadow architecture, with particular attention to spot. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Spot is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with point is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for spot; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep point behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Shadow", "ShadowArchitecture");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.11 and spot.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.11 Shadow architecture

Data model: point

This page defines the data model for Shadow architecture, with particular attention to point. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Point is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with atlases is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for point; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep atlases behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ShadowArchitectureService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ShadowArchitectureConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ShadowArchitectureState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.11 and point.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.11 Shadow architecture

Public API: atlases

This page defines the public api for Shadow architecture, with particular attention to atlases. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Atlases is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with cache is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for atlases; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep cache behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Shadow", "ShadowArchitecture");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.11 and atlases.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.11 Shadow architecture

Ownership and lifetime: cache

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Shadow architecture, with particular attention to cache. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Cache is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with bias is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for cache; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep bias behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ShadowArchitectureService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ShadowArchitectureConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ShadowArchitectureState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.11 and cache.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.11 Shadow architecture

Threading model: bias

This page defines the threading model for Shadow architecture, with particular attention to bias. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Bias is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with directional cascades is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for bias; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep directional cascades behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Shadow", "ShadowArchitecture");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.11 and bias.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.11 Shadow architecture

Memory strategy: directional cascades

This page defines the memory strategy for Shadow architecture, with particular attention to directional cascades. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Directional cascades is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with spot is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for directional cascades; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep spot behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ShadowArchitectureService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ShadowArchitectureConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ShadowArchitectureState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.11 and directional cascades.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.11 Shadow architecture

Failure handling: spot

This page defines the failure handling for Shadow architecture, with particular attention to spot. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Spot is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with point is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for spot; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep point behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Shadow", "ShadowArchitecture");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.11 and spot.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.11 Shadow architecture

Diagnostics: point

This page defines the diagnostics for Shadow architecture, with particular attention to point. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Point is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with atlases is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for point; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep atlases behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ShadowArchitectureService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ShadowArchitectureConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ShadowArchitectureState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.11 and point.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.11 Shadow architecture

Implementation sequence: atlases

This page defines the implementation sequence for Shadow architecture, with particular attention to atlases. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Atlases is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with cache is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for atlases; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep cache behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Shadow", "ShadowArchitecture");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.11 and atlases.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.11 Shadow architecture

Verification: cache

This page defines the verification for Shadow architecture, with particular attention to cache. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Cache is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with bias is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for cache; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep bias behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ShadowArchitectureService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ShadowArchitectureConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ShadowArchitectureState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.11 and cache.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.11 Shadow architecture

Completion gate: bias

This page defines the completion gate for Shadow architecture, with particular attention to bias. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Bias is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with directional cascades is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for bias; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep directional cascades behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Shadow", "ShadowArchitecture");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.11 and bias.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.11 Shadow architecture

Purpose and boundary: directional cascades

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Shadow architecture, with particular attention to directional cascades. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Directional cascades is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with spot is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for directional cascades; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep spot behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ShadowArchitectureService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ShadowArchitectureConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ShadowArchitectureState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.11 and directional cascades.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.11 Shadow architecture

Architecture: spot

This page defines the architecture for Shadow architecture, with particular attention to spot. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Spot is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with point is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for spot; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep point behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Shadow", "ShadowArchitecture");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.11 and spot.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.11 Shadow architecture

Data model: point

This page defines the data model for Shadow architecture, with particular attention to point. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Point is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with atlases is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for point; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep atlases behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ShadowArchitectureService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ShadowArchitectureConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ShadowArchitectureState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.11 and point.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.11 Shadow architecture

Public API: atlases

This page defines the public api for Shadow architecture, with particular attention to atlases. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Atlases is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with cache is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for atlases; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep cache behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Shadow", "ShadowArchitecture");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.11 and atlases.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.11 Shadow architecture

Ownership and lifetime: cache

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Shadow architecture, with particular attention to cache. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Cache is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with bias is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for cache; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep bias behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ShadowArchitectureService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ShadowArchitectureConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ShadowArchitectureState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.11 and cache.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.11 Shadow architecture

Threading model: bias

This page defines the threading model for Shadow architecture, with particular attention to bias. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Bias is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with directional cascades is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for bias; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep directional cascades behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Shadow", "ShadowArchitecture");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.11 and bias.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.11 Shadow architecture

Memory strategy: directional cascades

This page defines the memory strategy for Shadow architecture, with particular attention to directional cascades. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Directional cascades is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with spot is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for directional cascades; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep spot behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ShadowArchitectureService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ShadowArchitectureConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ShadowArchitectureState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.11 and directional cascades.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.11 Shadow architecture

Failure handling: spot

This page defines the failure handling for Shadow architecture, with particular attention to spot. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Spot is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with point is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for spot; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep point behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Shadow", "ShadowArchitecture");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.11 and spot.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.12 Sky, atmosphere and fog

Purpose and boundary: sky model

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Sky, atmosphere and fog, with particular attention to sky model. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Sky model is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with environment maps is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for sky model; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep environment maps behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SkyAtmosphereAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SkyAtmosphereAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SkyAtmosphereAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.12 and sky model.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.12 Sky, atmosphere and fog

Architecture: environment maps

This page defines the architecture for Sky, atmosphere and fog, with particular attention to environment maps. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Environment maps is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with height fog is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for environment maps; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep height fog behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Sky", "SkyAtmosphereAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.12 and environment maps.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.12 Sky, atmosphere and fog

Data model: height fog

This page defines the data model for Sky, atmosphere and fog, with particular attention to height fog. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Height fog is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with volumetrics deferred is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for height fog; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep volumetrics deferred behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SkyAtmosphereAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SkyAtmosphereAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SkyAtmosphereAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.12 and height fog.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.12 Sky, atmosphere and fog

Public API: volumetrics deferred

This page defines the public api for Sky, atmosphere and fog, with particular attention to volumetrics deferred. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Volumetrics deferred is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with sky model is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for volumetrics deferred; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep sky model behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Sky", "SkyAtmosphereAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.12 and volumetrics deferred.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.12 Sky, atmosphere and fog

Ownership and lifetime: sky model

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Sky, atmosphere and fog, with particular attention to sky model. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Sky model is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with environment maps is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for sky model; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep environment maps behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SkyAtmosphereAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SkyAtmosphereAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SkyAtmosphereAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.12 and sky model.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.12 Sky, atmosphere and fog

Threading model: environment maps

This page defines the threading model for Sky, atmosphere and fog, with particular attention to environment maps. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Environment maps is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with height fog is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for environment maps; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep height fog behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Sky", "SkyAtmosphereAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.12 and environment maps.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.12 Sky, atmosphere and fog

Memory strategy: height fog

This page defines the memory strategy for Sky, atmosphere and fog, with particular attention to height fog. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Height fog is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with volumetrics deferred is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for height fog; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep volumetrics deferred behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SkyAtmosphereAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SkyAtmosphereAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SkyAtmosphereAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.12 and height fog.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.12 Sky, atmosphere and fog

Failure handling: volumetrics deferred

This page defines the failure handling for Sky, atmosphere and fog, with particular attention to volumetrics deferred. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Volumetrics deferred is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with sky model is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for volumetrics deferred; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep sky model behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Sky", "SkyAtmosphereAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.12 and volumetrics deferred.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.12 Sky, atmosphere and fog

Diagnostics: sky model

This page defines the diagnostics for Sky, atmosphere and fog, with particular attention to sky model. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Sky model is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with environment maps is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for sky model; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep environment maps behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SkyAtmosphereAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SkyAtmosphereAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SkyAtmosphereAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.12 and sky model.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.12 Sky, atmosphere and fog

Implementation sequence: environment maps

This page defines the implementation sequence for Sky, atmosphere and fog, with particular attention to environment maps. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Environment maps is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with height fog is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for environment maps; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep height fog behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Sky", "SkyAtmosphereAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.12 and environment maps.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.12 Sky, atmosphere and fog

Verification: height fog

This page defines the verification for Sky, atmosphere and fog, with particular attention to height fog. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Height fog is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with volumetrics deferred is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for height fog; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep volumetrics deferred behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SkyAtmosphereAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SkyAtmosphereAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SkyAtmosphereAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.12 and height fog.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.13 Post-processing stack

Purpose and boundary: exposure

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Post-processing stack, with particular attention to exposure. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Exposure is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with tone mapping is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for exposure; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep tone mapping behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PostProcessingStackService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PostProcessingStackConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PostProcessingStackState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.13 and exposure.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.13 Post-processing stack

Architecture: tone mapping

This page defines the architecture for Post-processing stack, with particular attention to tone mapping. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Tone mapping is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with bloom is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for tone mapping; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep bloom behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Post", "PostProcessingStack");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.13 and tone mapping.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.13 Post-processing stack

Data model: bloom

This page defines the data model for Post-processing stack, with particular attention to bloom. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Bloom is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with TAA is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for bloom; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep TAA behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PostProcessingStackService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PostProcessingStackConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PostProcessingStackState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.13 and bloom.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.13 Post-processing stack

Public API: TAA

This page defines the public api for Post-processing stack, with particular attention to TAA. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Taa is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with FXAA is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for TAA; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep FXAA behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Post", "PostProcessingStack");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.13 and TAA.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.13 Post-processing stack

Ownership and lifetime: FXAA

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Post-processing stack, with particular attention to FXAA. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Fxaa is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with SSAO is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for FXAA; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep SSAO behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PostProcessingStackService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PostProcessingStackConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PostProcessingStackState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.13 and FXAA.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.13 Post-processing stack

Threading model: SSAO

This page defines the threading model for Post-processing stack, with particular attention to SSAO. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Ssao is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with DOF is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for SSAO; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep DOF behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Post", "PostProcessingStack");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.13 and SSAO.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.13 Post-processing stack

Memory strategy: DOF

This page defines the memory strategy for Post-processing stack, with particular attention to DOF. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Dof is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with motion blur is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for DOF; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep motion blur behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PostProcessingStackService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PostProcessingStackConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PostProcessingStackState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.13 and DOF.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.13 Post-processing stack

Failure handling: motion blur

This page defines the failure handling for Post-processing stack, with particular attention to motion blur. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Motion blur is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with exposure is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for motion blur; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep exposure behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Post", "PostProcessingStack");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.13 and motion blur.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.13 Post-processing stack

Diagnostics: exposure

This page defines the diagnostics for Post-processing stack, with particular attention to exposure. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Exposure is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with tone mapping is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for exposure; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep tone mapping behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PostProcessingStackService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PostProcessingStackConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PostProcessingStackState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.13 and exposure.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.13 Post-processing stack

Implementation sequence: tone mapping

This page defines the implementation sequence for Post-processing stack, with particular attention to tone mapping. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Tone mapping is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with bloom is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for tone mapping; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep bloom behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Post", "PostProcessingStack");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.13 and tone mapping.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.13 Post-processing stack

Verification: bloom

This page defines the verification for Post-processing stack, with particular attention to bloom. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Bloom is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with TAA is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for bloom; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep TAA behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PostProcessingStackService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PostProcessingStackConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PostProcessingStackState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.13 and bloom.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.13 Post-processing stack

Completion gate: TAA

This page defines the completion gate for Post-processing stack, with particular attention to TAA. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Taa is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with FXAA is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for TAA; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep FXAA behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Post", "PostProcessingStack");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.13 and TAA.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.13 Post-processing stack

Purpose and boundary: FXAA

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Post-processing stack, with particular attention to FXAA. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Fxaa is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with SSAO is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for FXAA; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep SSAO behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PostProcessingStackService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PostProcessingStackConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PostProcessingStackState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.13 and FXAA.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.13 Post-processing stack

Architecture: SSAO

This page defines the architecture for Post-processing stack, with particular attention to SSAO. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Ssao is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with DOF is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for SSAO; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep DOF behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Post", "PostProcessingStack");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.13 and SSAO.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.13 Post-processing stack

Data model: DOF

This page defines the data model for Post-processing stack, with particular attention to DOF. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Dof is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with motion blur is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for DOF; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep motion blur behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PostProcessingStackService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PostProcessingStackConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PostProcessingStackState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.13 and DOF.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.13 Post-processing stack

Public API: motion blur

This page defines the public api for Post-processing stack, with particular attention to motion blur. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Motion blur is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with exposure is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for motion blur; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep exposure behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Post", "PostProcessingStack");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.13 and motion blur.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.13 Post-processing stack

Ownership and lifetime: exposure

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Post-processing stack, with particular attention to exposure. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Exposure is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with tone mapping is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for exposure; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep tone mapping behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PostProcessingStackService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PostProcessingStackConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PostProcessingStackState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.13 and exposure.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.13 Post-processing stack

Threading model: tone mapping

This page defines the threading model for Post-processing stack, with particular attention to tone mapping. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Tone mapping is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with bloom is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for tone mapping; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep bloom behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Post", "PostProcessingStack");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.13 and tone mapping.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.13 Post-processing stack

Memory strategy: bloom

This page defines the memory strategy for Post-processing stack, with particular attention to bloom. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Bloom is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with TAA is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for bloom; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep TAA behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PostProcessingStackService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PostProcessingStackConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PostProcessingStackState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.13 and bloom.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.14 Editor and debug rendering

Purpose and boundary: selection

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Editor and debug rendering, with particular attention to selection. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Selection is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with gizmos is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for selection; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep gizmos behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class EditorAndDebugService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const EditorAndDebugConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    EditorAndDebugState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.14 and selection.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.14 Editor and debug rendering

Architecture: gizmos

This page defines the architecture for Editor and debug rendering, with particular attention to gizmos. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Gizmos is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with wireframe is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for gizmos; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep wireframe behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Editor", "EditorAndDebug");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.14 and gizmos.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.14 Editor and debug rendering

Data model: wireframe

This page defines the data model for Editor and debug rendering, with particular attention to wireframe. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Wireframe is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with buffer views is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for wireframe; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep buffer views behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class EditorAndDebugService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const EditorAndDebugConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    EditorAndDebugState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.14 and wireframe.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.14 Editor and debug rendering

Public API: buffer views

This page defines the public api for Editor and debug rendering, with particular attention to buffer views. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Buffer views is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with overdraw is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for buffer views; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep overdraw behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Editor", "EditorAndDebug");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.14 and buffer views.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.14 Editor and debug rendering

Ownership and lifetime: overdraw

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Editor and debug rendering, with particular attention to overdraw. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Overdraw is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with selection is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for overdraw; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep selection behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class EditorAndDebugService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const EditorAndDebugConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    EditorAndDebugState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.14 and overdraw.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.14 Editor and debug rendering

Threading model: selection

This page defines the threading model for Editor and debug rendering, with particular attention to selection. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Selection is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with gizmos is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for selection; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep gizmos behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Editor", "EditorAndDebug");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.14 and selection.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.14 Editor and debug rendering

Memory strategy: gizmos

This page defines the memory strategy for Editor and debug rendering, with particular attention to gizmos. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Gizmos is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with wireframe is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for gizmos; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep wireframe behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class EditorAndDebugService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const EditorAndDebugConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    EditorAndDebugState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.14 and gizmos.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.14 Editor and debug rendering

Failure handling: wireframe

This page defines the failure handling for Editor and debug rendering, with particular attention to wireframe. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Wireframe is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with buffer views is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for wireframe; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep buffer views behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Editor", "EditorAndDebug");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.14 and wireframe.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.14 Editor and debug rendering

Diagnostics: buffer views

This page defines the diagnostics for Editor and debug rendering, with particular attention to buffer views. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Buffer views is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with overdraw is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for buffer views; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep overdraw behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class EditorAndDebugService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const EditorAndDebugConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    EditorAndDebugState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.14 and buffer views.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.15 Renderer performance and image tests

Purpose and boundary: golden scenes

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Renderer performance and image tests, with particular attention to golden scenes. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Golden scenes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with frame budgets is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for golden scenes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep frame budgets behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RendererPerformanceAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RendererPerformanceAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RendererPerformanceAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.15 and golden scenes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.15 Renderer performance and image tests

Architecture: frame budgets

This page defines the architecture for Renderer performance and image tests, with particular attention to frame budgets. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Frame budgets is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with GPU timing is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for frame budgets; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep GPU timing behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Renderer", "RendererPerformanceAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.15 and frame budgets.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.15 Renderer performance and image tests

Data model: GPU timing

This page defines the data model for Renderer performance and image tests, with particular attention to GPU timing. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Gpu timing is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with cross-backend parity is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for GPU timing; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep cross-backend parity behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RendererPerformanceAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RendererPerformanceAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RendererPerformanceAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.15 and GPU timing.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.15 Renderer performance and image tests

Public API: cross-backend parity

This page defines the public api for Renderer performance and image tests, with particular attention to cross-backend parity. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Cross-backend parity is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with golden scenes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for cross-backend parity; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep golden scenes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Renderer", "RendererPerformanceAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.15 and cross-backend parity.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.15 Renderer performance and image tests

Ownership and lifetime: golden scenes

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Renderer performance and image tests, with particular attention to golden scenes. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Golden scenes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with frame budgets is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for golden scenes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep frame budgets behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RendererPerformanceAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RendererPerformanceAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RendererPerformanceAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.15 and golden scenes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.15 Renderer performance and image tests

Threading model: frame budgets

This page defines the threading model for Renderer performance and image tests, with particular attention to frame budgets. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Frame budgets is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with GPU timing is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for frame budgets; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep GPU timing behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Renderer", "RendererPerformanceAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.15 and frame budgets.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.15 Renderer performance and image tests

Memory strategy: GPU timing

This page defines the memory strategy for Renderer performance and image tests, with particular attention to GPU timing. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Gpu timing is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with cross-backend parity is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for GPU timing; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep cross-backend parity behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RendererPerformanceAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RendererPerformanceAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RendererPerformanceAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.15 and GPU timing.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.15 Renderer performance and image tests

Failure handling: cross-backend parity

This page defines the failure handling for Renderer performance and image tests, with particular attention to cross-backend parity. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Cross-backend parity is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with golden scenes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for cross-backend parity; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep golden scenes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Renderer", "RendererPerformanceAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.15 and cross-backend parity.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.15 Renderer performance and image tests

Diagnostics: golden scenes

This page defines the diagnostics for Renderer performance and image tests, with particular attention to golden scenes. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Golden scenes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with frame budgets is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for golden scenes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep frame budgets behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RendererPerformanceAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RendererPerformanceAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RendererPerformanceAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.15 and golden scenes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.15 Renderer performance and image tests

Implementation sequence: frame budgets

This page defines the implementation sequence for Renderer performance and image tests, with particular attention to frame budgets. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Frame budgets is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with GPU timing is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for frame budgets; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep GPU timing behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Renderer", "RendererPerformanceAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.15 and frame budgets.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.15 Renderer performance and image tests

Verification: GPU timing

This page defines the verification for Renderer performance and image tests, with particular attention to GPU timing. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Gpu timing is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with cross-backend parity is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for GPU timing; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep cross-backend parity behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class RendererPerformanceAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const RendererPerformanceAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    RendererPerformanceAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.15 and GPU timing.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

05.15 Renderer performance and image tests

Completion gate: cross-backend parity

This page defines the completion gate for Renderer performance and image tests, with particular attention to cross-backend parity. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Cross-backend parity is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with golden scenes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for cross-backend parity; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep golden scenes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Renderer", "RendererPerformanceAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 05.15 and cross-backend parity.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.